

Profile

Personal Information

Name Okita, Swaib *Ouma*
Preferred Name Jimmy
Sex, Birthdate Male, 12/10/1999

Contact Details

Email, Phone swaibokita7@gmail.com, +254.708121767, Mobile, +254.733949281, Mobile
Permanent Address P.O BOX 2517 Kitengela Road Onyonka Estate, Langata, Nairobi, Nairobi, 00200, KEN
Alternate Address Equity Group Foundation 8th Floor Equity Centre Hospital Road, Upperhill, Nairobi, Nairobi, 00200, KEN

Demographics

Hispanic or Latino No
Race Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Dholuo Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Nairobi, Kenya (< 1 Year US, 18 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa F-1 Student, 20160816190001 Issued: 03/22/2016
Intended US Visa

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested Yes, Signed: Swaib Okita
I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader

Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Dr. Benson O Ouma
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	okita@savetheelephants.org, +254.733949281, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	Conservationist or forester, Employed, Head of Monitoring, Save The Elephants
Education	Graduate school Doctorate (2014), Wageningen University and Research, Wageningen, Gelderland, NLD Masters (2004), University of Kent, Kent, GBR Bachelors (1997), Moi University, Eldoret, Uasin Gishu , KEN

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. Sophy W Okita (Barasa)
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	sophybarasa2000@gmail.com, +254.718611018, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	College teacher, Employed, Graduate lecturer, Rift Valley Institute of Science and Technology , Nakuru, Nakuru, KEN
Education	Graduate school Bachelors (1996), Moi University, Eldoret, Uasin Gishu, KEN Masters (2001), Kenyatta University, Nairobi, Nairobi , KEN

Siblings

1. Bady M Okita, Age 20, Brother, Some college/university, Bachelors, (07/2016 - 06/2020), **Strathmore University, Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN**
2. Rajan K Okita, Age 15, Brother, Some high/secondary school
3. Hawi J Okita, Age 9, Sister, Some grade/primary school

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

Alliance High School, Kikuyu, KEN, Public, CEEB: 619330 (02/2014 - 11/2017)

Counselor Ms. Gladys A Otido, Teacher

Phone +254.722354971

Boarding School Yes: Living at School

Progression Did or will take gap year

Graduation Date 11/2017

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 3 / 378, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
Mathematics	Mathematics	Mathematics
English	English	English
Kiswahili	Kiswahili	Kiswahili
Physics	Physics	Physics
Chemistry	Chemistry	Chemistry
Biology	Biology	Biology
Geography	Geography	Geography
Computer Studies	Computer Studies	Computer Studies

Honors

Best student in essay writing in the World Scholars Cup 2016. International 11

Third best overall student in the World Scholars Cup 2016. International 11

35th best student among 615,284 candidates in the KCSE National Examinations 2017.	National	12
1st project in the Kenya Science and Engineering Fair	National	12
8th place Kenya Mathematics Olympiad 2016.	National	11

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	Equity Leadership Program
Counselor	Mr. Edwin Kuria
Email, Phone	edwin.kuria@equitybank.co.ke, +254.764320202

Future Plans

Business owner or proprietor, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	740	10/06/2018
Math	770	10/06/2018
Essay	19	10/06/2018
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Math Level 1	740	11/2018
Physics	720	11/2018
Math Level 2	640	11/2018

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
English	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Geography	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Computer Studies	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	A-	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A-	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Biology	B+	11/2018, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Foreign Exchange

11	2016 Exchange fellow to Brooks School, MA.
School	Joined class mid-year; carried out research trying to generate electrical current as electrons flowed to neutralize a positively-charged electroscope.
168 hr/wk, 9 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12, PG	Teaching & marketing Assistant; Sobra Star School.
Break	Tutor of remedial classes during school holidays;organized Family Fun Day;linked school with Change Makers in Slums who began agriculture project.
40 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr	
Continue	

Student Govt./Politics

10, 11, 12	House Chair; House Captain;General Committee Chair
School	Maintaining order in Livingstone House; Coordinating inter-house activities and inter-school socials; Overlooking all clubs; Best overall house '16,17
14 hr/wk, 35 wk/yr	
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

9, 10, 11, 12	Patrol Leader; Kenya Scouts Association
School, Break	In charge of all scouts in school; Organizing camps; Achieved all Mwamba stage proficiency badges(Mwanzo, Mwangaza, Kilele, Bushman thong)
12 hr/wk, 38 wk/yr	
Continue	

Religious

11, 12	Librarian and Financial Officer; Christian Union.
School	Organized visits to old people's homes and hospitals each week; Outsourced preachers; Introduced new food items which the club sold to increase profit
4 hr/wk, 35 wk/yr	
Continue	

Science/Math

10, 11, 12	Vice Chairman;Mathematics Club
School	Organized Mathematics Contests; Printed papers for extra Math tuition; First in Loreto Mathematics Olympiad(2016)
7 hr/wk, 35 wk/yr	
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

PG	Founder, Watoto Wetu Foundation
Year	Sponsoring needy bright children through their primary education and ensuring they are taken under the Equity Wings to Fly Program for high school.
14 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr	
Continue	

Internship

11	Intern; MODE Kenya, a financial technology company
Break	Gained some working experience; Created and presented a project 'Agrobro' that sought to redefine the structure and working of Kenyan agriculture.
40 hr/wk, 2 wk/yr	
Continue	

Debate/Speech

12	Sub-Saharan International Model United Nations
School	Team Leader of school delegates to SAIMUN 17;Wrote and sponsored draft resolution paper that was tabled before the general assembly;Team ranked second
40 hr/wk, 1 wk/yr	
Continue	

Work (Paid)

PG	Employee; Equity Leaders Program
Break	Worked as a cashier at an Equity Bank branch; Developed an inventory system for the branch; Voted as the Most Creative and Innovative employee.
61 hr/wk, 28 wk/yr	
Continue	

Writing

Personal Essay

Share an essay on any topic of your choice. It can be one you've already written, one that responds to a different prompt, or one of your own design.

I treat my elation whenever a bird poops on my head (a symbol of good fortune), and my disappointment whenever I am rejected by my community because of the scars left in the wake of my eczema, the same way.

You may class this as indifference. You may regard it as a failure to grasp the magnitude of two events on extreme ends of the spectrum. Nevertheless, where I am concerned, there's no better way to keep my emotions in check than through external self-talk. I named this attribute, around which my inner life revolves, Jimmy after my nickname. Jimmy has since become my alter ego. I am not oblivious to the criticism that comes along with talking to myself. Indeed, people have asked me if I have lost my mind.

My primary school compelled me to acknowledge, with taunts, that I was different. I objectively asked my teacher why 'A' was for Apple and not Animal. That was the beginning of our strife. She once intercepted a precious note to my friend, written in the hazed scribbling of an excited child, detailing the words "Found new word today! 'French letter!'" She was aghast. Before she sent me to the principal for interrupting her class, she said coldly, "This is a symptom of idiocy. *She* is a hopeless case." Though deeply hurt, I was content – even amid the peals of laughter that ensued- that my curiosity was temporarily sated, safe in the knowledge that everybody would now know what 'French letter' meant.

I ran home after school, consumed by a fire to vent out. Assuming the role of my teacher, complete with a cane in hand, I turned to our mud walls, my imaginary students, to teach.

"Repeat after me. One! Two! Three!"

Quiet.

"I said repeat after me. One! Two! Three!"

The silence that followed made me discipline 'them' uniformly. I repeated my instruction, to which 'they' never replied, prompting me to cane 'them'. Thus, my evening routine developed. Over time, I began talking to 'them', explaining why 'they' should respond. I tried to ensure that 'they' never felt caged by what other students expected 'them' to say. Unbeknownst to me at the time, I was getting across the values I believed in. In this manner, I overcame bullying, barricading my sensitive nature behind Jimmy and outward indifference.

As I grew up, I morphed into a potter. Using the fine clay I scooped at the riverbed, I modelled my familiar background comprising cattle and a herdsman. I ordered the shepherd around, illustrating without difficulty where he should take each cow.

"You forgot to bring Maria (the most adventurous cow) home," I would say to him in my father's stern voice. "Don't repeat that."

In case he forgot Maria again, I crushed him and modelled another herder, echoing my father's words that there was no place for the mediocre. Seeing no notable improvements, I decided to give shepherds more chances, while enabling them understand why bringing cows home on time was important, making me get a better sense of authority. I imagined governing students, who, so like myself, needed guidance and control. Consequently, with immense practice, I recreated my classroom environment.

With each new responsibility over the years, I had less time to model or to play with my students on the wall.

Jimmy had become my internal figure of power who corrected and motivated me. In times when I was in command, the first time as a class monitor in fourth grade, Jimmy helped me come out as strong-willed and impartial, achieving the very qualities I wish to embody in governance. In the weeks after I froze while giving my presidential speech in high school, he helped me practice eloquence, master confidence, and speak off-the-cuff. Stern but compassionate, I attained the temperate of effective leaders.

Today, I am proud of my self-talk, a quality sometimes universally painted negatively.

Additional Information

The following are updates on some of my ongoing activities and personal achievements:

1. Artsiva: (www.artsiva.com)

In just three months since I founded this blog, it has grown from a single man's project to a team of eleven employees with thirty-eight different voluntary writers. As of December 15, 2018, we have forty-six blog posts that have been read across thirty-one countries. We have also been nominated for the Bloggers Association of Kenya (BAKE) Awards 2019.

2. Watoto Wetu Foundation:

The Kenya Certificate of Primary Education results were recently released and the two students the foundation sponsored this year had good grades that led to them being admitted to some of the best schools in the country. We also received a donation from the Oanda Family that will help us sponsor five students next year.

3. Treo-B Software Company (www.treob.co.ke)

We have seventeen completed projects so far varying from school management systems and hospital management systems to church management systems, point of sale terminals, and websites. Currently, there are three ongoing projects that we are working on.

4. Kenya just celebrated the 55th Jamhuri (Independence) Day on 12th December 2018. I received an honorary mention from the President of the Republic of Kenya due to some of my efforts this year.

5. Hashtag Kenya, a popular Teenager's magazine, mentioned me among the top ten most outstanding teenagers of 2018.

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

A week after I left school, I held the *Tisa Tisa Festival*, a social event that brought students together to network and celebrate life(the death rate of pupils was surprisingly high)on 6th December 2017.

I then launched a crowdfund(<https://www.gofundme.com/entertainment-business-for-fees/>) to raise capital to start a gaming lounge whose profits would sponsor needy children. Although I raised no money from it, donations from friends and family helped me open a subsidized version of the lounge. Its yield sponsors two children.

This propelled me to found *Watoto Wetu Foundation* focused on transitioning these beneficiaries into the *Equity Bank's Wings to Fly Program* which caters for post-primary education.

I joined the *Equity Leadership Program* and I have spent seven months working as a cashier at Equity Bank Community Branch. My counter was dedicated to serving customers aged 70+ and handling forex.

I invested my salary in a small kiosk where I sold grilled chicken tikka after work. The gains helped me purchase basic necessities for home use, and support community-oriented projects.

I co-founded a software company(www.treob.co.ke)that tailor-makes websites. We have made about 17 systems so far, including an automated inventory system for Equity Bank.

I recently launched my blog(www.artsiva.com)that addresses societal issues in a creative way.

I am a part-time teacher at Sobra Star School, a small private school situated in a rather poor locale. I linked it with Change Makers in Slums(<http://changemakerinslums.com/>)which starts income-generating projects with schools across the globe.

I assist my parents with chores and find time to meet friends

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Have you ever been adjudicated guilty or convicted of a misdemeanor or felony?

No

University of Pennsylvania Questions

General

Start Term	Fall 2019
Admission plan	Regular Decision
School Specific Fee Waivers	No
Financial aid	Yes
University of Pennsylvania allows submission of an external portfolio so that your special talent in one or more of the arts will be considered as part of the admission process. Do you plan to submit one to University of Pennsylvania?	No

Academics

Primary School/Program to Which You Are Applying	The Wharton School
Primary Major of Interest	Business Economics and Public Policy

Contacts

Previously applied	No
How have you learned about University of Pennsylvania? List in order of influence	Internet
Additional contact	College Counselor, Gladys Otido
Additional contact	Current Penn Student, Andrew Adallah
Additional contact	Friend/Classmate, Christine Nyambura

If you wish to be contacted via mobile phone, please provide your phone number. Contact methods may include phone calls generated from an automated telephone dialing system or text messaging.

I consent to be contacted by University of Pennsylvania at the mobile phone number provided below.

Mobile Phone Number: +254.708121767

Family

Sibling applied No

Relatives attended member No

Relative employed at member No

Other Information

Do you hold permanent residence status in Canada or Mexico? No

Identity Details Yes

Preferred Pronouns He/Him

Would you like to provide information regarding personal identification with the LGBTQ+ community? (optional) No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.